School Fee & Results Management System

User Manual

A step-by-step guide for School Admins, Accountants, Teachers, school leadership, and parents

Osubula Talks Solutions

Updated October 2026

If you get stuck on anything not covered here, see the Getting Help chapter at the end of this manual.

Table of Contents

1. Getting Started . . . 3
2. Managing Pupils / Students . . . 5
3. Managing Classes . . . 8
4. Fee Structures . . . 9
5. Transport Zones . . . 10
6. Meal Zones . . . 11
7. Recording Payments . . . 12
8. Academic Terms & the Termly Summary Report . . . 13
9. Grading Scales . . . 14
10. Exams & Results . . . 15
11. Attendance . . . 16
12. Term Reports (Per-Pupil) . . . 17
13. Staff Management . . . 18
14. School Settings & Branding . . . 19
15. Parents & Guardians . . . 20
16. News & Circulars . . . 22
17. SMS Alerts for Posts . . . 24
18. School Updates & the Parent Login . . . 25
19. Activity History & Alerts . . . 26
20. Year-End Transition . . . 27
21. Nursery (Kindergarten) Ratings . . . 28
22. Continuous Assessment: Topics & AoI Scores . . . 29
23. Connecting MTN Mobile Money . . . 30
24. Frequently Asked Questions . . . 31
25. Getting Help . . . 33

Chapter 1: Getting Started

Logging In

Your school administrator will give you a login link, an email address, and a password. Open the link in any web browser (Chrome, Safari, or Edge all work) on a computer, tablet, or phone.

> **Note:** If you ever forget your password, ask your School Admin to reset it for you from the Staff page (see Chapter 13). Parents should ask the school office.

> **Tip:** You can add the system to a phone like an app. Open it in your browser, then choose Add to Home screen (or Install app) from the browser menu. It then opens with its own icon.

For safety, you are signed out automatically after a period of inactivity. Just sign in again.

Understanding Roles

The system shows different things depending on your role. Each person gets only what their job needs.

Role	What you can do
School Admin	Everything at the school: pupils, fees, transport and meal zones, payments, terms, exams, attendance, staff, settings, News & Circulars, and SMS alerts.
Accountant	Views pupils, classes and terms. Creates fee structures, generates transport and meal fees, records payments, and sends fee reminders by SMS. No exams, attendance, staff or settings.
Teacher	Sees only the classes an admin has assigned to them. Creates exams, enters scores, and marks attendance. No access to fees or payments.
Principal and Deputy Principal	Run the school day to day: pupils, classes, promotion, terms, exams, scores, term reports, attendance, parents and guardians, and News & Circulars. No fees, payments or SMS, and no staff accounts or school settings. Receive alerts for critical changes.
Director of Studies	Academic oversight: exams, scores, subjects, grading scales and attendance. Views pupils, classes and terms. No access to finances.
Director	View only. Sees how the school is performing, including finances and the activity history, and cannot change anything. Receives alerts for critical changes.
Parent	Has their own simple view: each child's fee balance and results, the term report, payment by MTN mobile money, and School Updates from the school.

> **Note:** If a menu item mentioned in this manual doesn't appear in your sidebar, it's simply because your role doesn't need it, not a fault.

Finding Your Way Around

The left-hand sidebar is your main menu. It changes slightly depending on your role, but the core areas are: Pupils, Classes, Fee Structures, Transport Zones, Meal Zones, Payments, Academic Terms, Grading Scales, Exams, Attendance, Topics, AoI Scores, Kindergarten Ratings, News & Circulars, Activity, Year-End Transition, Staff, and Settings. Click any item to go straight to that section. Parents see Overview and School Updates.

If you receive alerts about important changes, a small bell appears near the bottom of the sidebar (see Chapter 19).

Working Without Internet

Recording a payment, entering exam scores, marking attendance, and adding a pupil keep working when there is no signal. The work is saved on your device and sent automatically once you are back online, and it is never recorded twice. Features that need to reach other people, such as News & Circulars and SMS alerts, need an internet connection.

Chapter 2: Managing Pupils / Students

Adding a New Pupil

SCHOOL ADMIN / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL

Teachers and Accountants can view pupils but not add or edit them. A teacher sees only the pupils in the classes assigned to them.

1. Click **Pupils** in the sidebar, then **+ Add pupil**.
2. Fill in the **Admission Number**, **First Name**, and **Last Name**, since these are required. **SchoolPay Code**, **House** and **Stream** are optional.
3. Optionally set **Gender**, **Class**, and **Section** (Boarding or Day). Nursery classes are not asked for a section.
4. If this pupil uses school transport or takes meals at school, select their **Transport zone** and/or **Meal zone** from the dropdowns, each of which shows its fee right in the list, e.g. "Zone A (UGX 40,000/term)".
5. Optionally, under **Fees for this term**, type this pupil's school, meal or transport fee directly. This section appears only for roles allowed to set fees, and needs a current term to be set up.
6. If you know the real date this pupil joined the school, enter it under **Admission date**. If you leave it blank, the system just uses today's date, which is fine for pupils joining now, but if you're entering someone who joined months or years ago, filling this in keeps your enrollment reports accurate.
7. Tick **Also add a parent or guardian** if you want to record their contact details right away, or skip this and add it later from the pupil's own page. See Chapter 15 for how the system checks for a parent who is already on file.
8. Click **Add pupil**.

> **Note:** When you add a pupil to a class, they are billed automatically for the fee structures that already exist for that class this term (see Chapter 4). You don't need to do anything extra. A class also holds a limited number of active pupils: if it is full, the system refuses and tells you.

Editing a Pupil

SCHOOL ADMIN / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL

Open the pupil from the Pupils list (click their name), then click **Edit**. You can change their name, class, section, transport zone, meal zone, and admission date at any time. Remember to click **Save changes** when done, since a common mistake is changing a dropdown and navigating away without saving.

> **Note:** If you change a pupil's Class here, it does not automatically update their fee balances for a term already billed. To move an entire class of pupils at year-end, use Bulk Promotion instead (see Chapter 3).

Importing Pupils from a Spreadsheet (CSV)

SCHOOL ADMIN / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL

If you're bringing in a whole class or the school's full roster at once, importing a CSV file is much faster than adding pupils one by one.

1. Click **Pupils**, then **Import CSV**.
2. Prepare your spreadsheet with these column headings in the first row: admission_no, first_name, last_name (required), and optionally gender, class_name, section, admission_date.
3. Save the spreadsheet as a .csv file, then upload it.
4. The system will tell you how many pupils were created, how many were updated, and list any rows that had a problem (like a class name that doesn't exist yet).

> **Note:** Re-uploading the same file later (to fix a typo, for example) is completely safe, since it updates the matching pupil by admission number rather than creating a duplicate.

Searching and Sorting the Pupil List

At the top of the Pupils page, type in the search box to find a pupil by name or admission number. Use the Sort dropdown to switch between:

- **Name (A-Z)**, alphabetical by surname, then first name (the default).
- **Class**, groups everyone by class, sorted by name within each class.
- **Admission No.**, orders by admission number.
- **Boarding**, boarding pupils first. **Day**, day pupils first. Pupils with no section on record come last either way.

Deactivating a Pupil

SCHOOL ADMIN / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL

If a pupil has left the school, open their page and click **Deactivate** rather than deleting them, since this keeps their full history (fees, results, reports) on record while removing them from active counts and class capacity. Deactivated pupils are listed separately under Deactivated Pupils in the sidebar. Deactivating or deleting a pupil sends an alert to school leadership (see Chapter 19).

A Pupil's Own Page

Clicking any pupil's name opens their own page, showing:

- **Fee balances**, every fee they owe this term, broken out by type (e.g. the base term fee, Transport, Meals), with Due, Paid, and Status for each.
- **Exam results**, their scores once entered.
- **Term Comments**, the class teacher's and behaviour comments for the current term.
- **Saved Term Reports**, official report snapshots you've saved for past terms.

- **Guardians**, the parents and guardians linked to this pupil, with a **+ Add guardian** button (see Chapter 15).

From here you can also **Print ID card** or **Download term report** for this pupil.

Chapter 3: Managing Classes

Creating a Class

SCHOOL ADMIN / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL

1. Click **Classes** in the sidebar.
2. Under **Class name**, type the class name (e.g. "P4" or "S2 East"), and optionally a **Level** (e.g. "Primary 4").
3. Click **Add class**.

Bulk Promoting an Entire Class

SCHOOL ADMIN / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL

At the end of a school year, you'll want to move everyone in one class up to the next, for example all of P4 into P5. Doing this one pupil at a time would take forever, so use Bulk Promotion instead.

1. From the Classes page, click **Promote students**.
2. Choose the **From class** (where pupils are moving out of) and the **To class** (where they're moving into).
3. Read the summary line, which tells you exactly how many active pupils will move.
4. Click **Promote students** and confirm.

> **Note:** This only ever moves ACTIVE pupils. It will refuse to run at all if the target class doesn't have enough room, rather than moving some pupils and leaving others behind, so if you see a capacity error, nothing has changed yet.

Undoing a Promotion for One Pupil

If one particular pupil was promoted by mistake, wrong class, held back a year, anything, you don't need to redo the whole bulk action. Open that pupil's own Edit page: underneath the Class dropdown, you'll see a link reading **Revert to [their previous class]**. Click it, confirm, and they'll move straight back.

> **Note:** This revert link only appears once, right after a promotion, and disappears once used, since it's a one-time undo, not something you can toggle back and forth repeatedly.

When the whole school is moving to a new year, the Year-End Transition (Chapter 20) promotes every class and creates the new terms in one action.

Chapter 4: Fee Structures

What a Fee Structure Is

A fee structure is what actually bills your pupils, tied to one class and one academic term, and lists the individual charges (fee items) that make it up, like Tuition, Development Fee, or Requirements. Every term, for every class, you'll typically create a fresh fee structure.

Creating a Fee Structure

SCHOOL ADMIN / ACCOUNTANT

1. Click **Fee Structures**, then **New fee structure**.
2. Give it a **Name** (e.g. "P4 Term 1 Fees"), and choose the **Class** and **Academic term** it applies to.
3. Under **Fee items**, type each item's name and amount, then click **+ Add another item** for more than one.
4. Tick **Optional** for any item that not everyone has to pay (this keeps it off the required total).
5. Click **Create fee structure**. This immediately generates a fee balance for every active pupil currently in that class.

> **Note:** A pupil who is added to the class later is billed automatically for this fee structure when you add them (see Chapter 2). If a class has no fee structure yet for the current term, create one first, since there is nothing to bill until then.

Charging Boarding and Day Pupils Different Amounts

Boarding and day pupils very often shouldn't pay the same tuition, since boarding usually costs more, since it covers accommodation. For any fee item where this applies:

1. Tick the checkbox **Different amount for Boarding vs Day students** underneath that item.
2. Two new fields appear, enter the **Boarding amount** and the **Day amount** separately.
3. You can leave the plain "Default" amount box empty when doing this, since it's only used as a fallback for a pupil with no Section set at all.

> **Note:** An item you do NOT tick this box for still charges everyone the exact same amount, regardless of section. Use the split only where it's actually needed, like Tuition, and leave it off for items like Requirements that cost the same for everyone.

Reassigning or Correcting a Fee Structure's Class

If you accidentally created a fee structure against the wrong class, and nobody has paid against it yet, you can change its class from the Fee Structures list. Once even one payment has been recorded, the system will no longer let you change it, since at that point it's a real financial record, and the correct move is creating a new fee structure instead.

Chapter 5: Transport Zones

Why Transport Zones Exist

Pupils travelling from different areas can't fairly be charged the same transport fee, since someone living 2km away and someone living 20km away have very different costs. Transport Zones let you set your own priced zones and assign each pupil to the one that fits them.

Creating a Zone

SCHOOL ADMIN ONLY

1. Click **Transport Zones** in the sidebar.
2. Click **Add transport zone**.
3. Give the zone a name (e.g. "Zone A", "Ntinda Route", or a distance description) and its fee per term.
4. Click **Save**.

You can create as many zones as you need, with whatever names make sense for your school.

Assigning a Pupil to a Zone

Open the pupil's Edit page, and under **Transport zone**, pick the zone that fits them. A pupil who doesn't use school transport should simply be left on "Not using school transport", and they will not be billed anything for it.

Generating Transport Fees

SCHOOL ADMIN / ACCOUNTANT

Creating zones and assigning pupils doesn't bill anyone by itself, you still need to generate the actual charges once, each term:

1. Go to **Transport Zones**.
2. Under **Generate transport fees**, click **Generate transport fees for [current term]**.
3. The result tells you how many pupils were billed, and how many active pupils have no zone assigned (correctly skipped, since they don't use the service).

> **Note:** This is completely safe to run more than once. It only bills pupils who don't already have a transport charge for that term, so if you assign a few more pupils to zones later in the term, just run it again to pick up the new ones, without double-billing anyone already charged.

Chapter 6: Meal Zones

Meal Zones work exactly like Transport Zones, but for meal options instead of distance, for example "Lunch only" or "Lunch + Snack", each with its own fee. This is most relevant for day pupils who choose to eat at school; boarding pupils typically already have meals covered by their boarding fee.

Creating a Zone

SCHOOL ADMIN ONLY

1. Click **Meal Zones** in the sidebar, then **Add meal zone**.
2. Name the option (e.g. "Lunch") and set its fee per term.
3. Click **Save**.

Assigning a Pupil

On the pupil's Edit page, choose their option under **Meal zone**, or leave it as "Not taking meals at school" if they bring their own food or it's already covered.

Generating Meal Fees

SCHOOL ADMIN / ACCOUNTANT

Just like Transport, go to Meal Zones and click **Generate meal fees for [current term]**. It's equally safe to run more than once, it only bills pupils newly assigned since the last time you ran it.

Chapter 7: Recording Payments

Recording a Payment

SCHOOL ADMIN / ACCOUNTANT

1. Click **Payments** in the sidebar.
2. Search for and select the pupil making a payment.
3. Choose which fee balance the payment is going toward (a pupil often has several, e.g. their base fee, Transport, and Meals, all separately).
4. Enter the amount and payment method (Cash, Bank Transfer, or Mobile Money, depending on what your school has set up).
5. Confirm to record it.

> **Note:** Always double-check you've picked the right fee balance before confirming, especially now that a pupil can have several separate balances in the same term.

Payments Made by Parents (MTN Mobile Money)

Parents can pay an outstanding balance themselves, from their own login, with MTN mobile money (see Chapter 18). Once MTN confirms the payment, the system records it against that balance. A payment that fails or is not approved is not recorded. These payments show in Recent Payments and in the Activity history like any other, so you don't need to enter them by hand.

Understanding Recent Payments

On the main Overview dashboard, the Recent Payments list shows each payment with two small badges: which fee type it was for (e.g. Transport, Meals, or the base term fee), and the payment method used. This makes it easy to see at a glance exactly what a parent's payment settled, without opening the pupil's full page.

Chapter 8: Academic Terms & the Termly Summary Report

Creating a New Term

SCHOOL ADMIN / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL

1. Click **Academic Terms**, and fill in the **Term name**, **Year**, **Start date**, and **End date**.
2. Tick **Set as the current term** if this term is starting now.
3. Click **Add term**.

> **Note:** Starting a new term does NOT automatically carry over fee structures, transport fees, or meal fees from the previous term, these all need to be freshly created (or, for Transport/Meals, freshly generated) for the new term. This is intentional, since amounts often change between terms.

Generating the Termly Summary Report

SCHOOL ADMIN / ACCOUNTANT

At the end of any term, or any time you want a full picture for a past one, you can generate a one-click Word document summarising everything the school's owner or director needs to know:

1. Click **Academic Terms**.
2. Find the term you want (this works for any past term too, not just the current one).
3. Click **Download summary report**. A Word (.docx) file downloads immediately.

The report covers: active pupils, admissions and departures for that term, total billed versus collected with a collection rate, a breakdown by fee type (Tuition, Transport, Meals, etc.), a Boarding vs Day split, active staff count, and a per-class breakdown showing which classes are lagging on collections.

> **Note:** The "Admitted this term" figure uses each pupil's Admission Date if you've set one (see Chapter 2), falling back to when their record was created in the system if not. If you bulk-imported your whole roster at once during onboarding, your very first report may show an inflated admissions number for that reason, but it settles into being accurate from then on.

Chapter 9: Grading Scales

A grading scale converts a raw score percentage into a letter grade (and an optional remark, like "Excellent" or "Very Good") on report cards.

1. Click **Grading Scales**, then create a new one, naming it and adding grade bands (e.g. "A: 80 to 100", "B: 70 to 79", and so on).
2. For each band, you can add a short comment (e.g. "Excellent"), and this automatically shows in the Remarks column of report cards whenever a pupil doesn't have a manually-typed remark of their own for that subject.
3. Mark one scale as **Default**, the one used for any exam that doesn't specify its own scale.

> **Note:** Once a grading scale has actually been used for a real exam, its bands can no longer be edited, since this stops a later policy change from silently altering how past exams were graded. Create a new scale instead if you need different bands going forward.

Chapter 10: Exams & Results

Creating an Exam

SCHOOL ADMIN / TEACHER / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL / DIRECTOR OF STUDIES

Click **Exams**, then create a new exam, give it a name (e.g. "Mid-term Exam"), assign it to a class and term, and choose which subjects it covers along with each subject's maximum score.

> **Note:** Double-check the exam name for typos before saving, since it appears exactly as typed on every pupil's report card.

Entering Scores

Open the exam and enter each pupil's score per subject, either one at a time or by importing a CSV of scores in bulk (following the same admission-number-based matching as the pupil CSV import). Teachers see only the exams for their own classes.

Composite Results

For subjects or assessments that combine multiple components into one overall mark (for example, coursework plus a final exam), use Composite Results to define how the components are weighted, and the system calculates the combined score automatically.

Chapter 11: Attendance

SCHOOL ADMIN / TEACHER / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL / DIRECTOR OF STUDIES

Click **Attendance**, choose a class and date, and mark each pupil Present or Absent. Attendance is recorded per class per day, and can be reviewed later by date or by pupil. A teacher can mark attendance only for the classes assigned to them. Marking attendance keeps working with no internet and is sent when the connection returns.

Chapter 12: Term Reports (Per-Pupil)

Separate from the school-wide Termly Summary Report (Chapter 8), each pupil has their own individual academic report for a term, covering their exam results, grades, remarks, fee balance, and class teacher's comments.

1. From a pupil's own page, click **Download term report** for an on-the-spot PDF.
2. To keep an official record on file, use **Add Term Report** to save a permanent snapshot to that pupil's history, useful for building a running record across their whole time at the school.
3. The class teacher's and behaviour comments for the term can be added or edited from the pupil's page under **Term Comments**.

School Admin, Principal and Deputy Principal can also browse the saved reports for the whole school under **Term Reports** in the sidebar.

Chapter 13: Staff Management

SCHOOL ADMIN ONLY

Click **Staff** to see everyone with a login to your school's account.

Adding a Staff Member

Choose **Add** and enter their name, email, and role (Chapter 1 explains what each role can do). You can either type a temporary password yourself, or let the system create a single-use setup link so the staff member chooses their own password. Until they use that link, the account cannot be signed in to.

Assigning a Teacher to Classes

Open a teacher and choose their classes. A teacher sees only the classes assigned to them, and sees nothing until at least one class is assigned.

Resetting a Staff Password

If a staff member has forgotten their password, start a reset from the Staff page. For safety, the system first sends a verification code to your own email, and the reset is applied only after you enter that code correctly. You can then either set a temporary password yourself, or give the staff member a single-use link so they choose their own.

Deactivating and Deleting Staff

When someone leaves, deactivate their account so they can no longer sign in. You can reactivate it later. Deleting an account removes it. Every staff action on this page is recorded in the Activity history and sends an alert to school leadership (see Chapter 19).

Chapter 14: School Settings & Branding

SCHOOL ADMIN ONLY

Click **Settings** to update your school's name, address, contact details, currency, and logo. Your logo appears on ID cards, report cards, and the termly summary report, so it's worth uploading a clear, square version early on.

The School Admin also connects the school's MTN mobile money account for parent payments from here (see Chapter 23).

Chapter 15: Parents & Guardians

SCHOOL ADMIN / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL

A parent or guardian is linked to a pupil. A parent with a portal login can sign in and see their children's balances, results and School Updates. One parent with three children at the school should have one record and one login covering all three, and the system helps you keep it that way.

Adding a Parent When You Add a Pupil

1. On the **Add pupil** page, tick **Also add a parent or guardian**.
2. Enter the guardian's **First name**, **Last name**, **Phone** and **Relationship**.
3. When you finish typing the phone number and move away from the field, the system checks whether a guardian with that number is already on file at your school.
4. If there is no match, carry on as normal. If there is a match, an amber box lists each person found, whether they have portal access, and which children they are already linked to.
5. Choose **Same person - link** if it is the same parent. The form shows a green card, and no new guardian record or login is created. Or choose **No, this is a different person - add as new** to keep typing a new guardian.
6. Save the pupil. The button stays disabled while a match is waiting for your decision.

> **Note:** If the matched parent already has a portal login, linking gives that login access to this pupil too. That is exactly what you want for a real parent, so be sure it is the same person before you link. The green card shows a warning when this applies. Use **Not the same person - go back** to undo your choice.

Adding a Parent from a Pupil's Page

Open the pupil, and click **+ Add guardian**. The same phone check happens: type the phone number and move away from the field, and the matching parent appears with **Same person - link** and **No, this is a different person - add as new**.

- Tick **Primary contact** for the main contact.
- To give a new parent a login, tick **Give this guardian parent-portal access**, then enter their **email** (their login) and a **temporary password** of at least 8 characters. Give both to the parent.
- An email address can belong to only one account. If it is already in use, the system tells you.

About Phone Numbers

The system turns any Ugandan number into one standard form, so 0789 318836 and +256 789 318836 are recognised as the same number.

Note: A phone number alone does not prove who someone is, since two relatives can share one phone. That is why the system never merges anyone by itself. It always shows you who it found and lets you decide, every time.

Chapter 16: News & Circulars

News & Circulars is where the school publishes newsletters, circulars, activity updates and announcements to parents. Parents read them under School Updates (Chapter 18).

SCHOOL ADMIN / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL

These three roles can create, edit, publish, archive and delete posts. Nobody else sees the News & Circulars menu.

Creating a Post

1. Click **News & Circulars** in the sidebar, then **+ New post**.
2. Type a **Title** and choose the **Type**: Newsletter, Circular, Activity, Announcement or Other. The type appears as a coloured badge for parents.
3. Write the content in the editor. The toolbar offers **Bold**, **Italic**, **Underline**, **Heading**, **Bullets**, **Numbers**, **Quote**, **Link**, **Image**, **Undo** and **Redo**. To add a photo, click **Image** and choose a JPEG, PNG or WEBP file under 4MB.
4. Optionally add an **Attachment**: a PDF, Word file or image under 4MB. Choosing a new file later replaces the old one.
5. Under **Who should see this?**, choose **All parents**, **Specific classes** (tick the classes), or **Specific sections** (Boarding, Day, or both).
6. Optionally set a **Publish date and time** and an **Expiry date and time**.
7. Click **Preview** to see exactly how parents will see the post, then **Save draft** or **Publish**.

> **Tip:** Phone photos are often larger than 4MB. If an image or attachment is refused, send it to yourself on WhatsApp first, which shrinks it, then use that copy. A scanned PDF can be re-saved at a lower quality.

Publishing, Scheduling and Expiry

- **Publish now.** Leave the publish time blank and press Publish. The system asks you to confirm, then parents see the post straight away.
- **Schedule.** Set a publish time in the future. The post shows as **Scheduled** and appears for parents automatically at that moment.
- **Expire.** Set an expiry time and the post disappears from parents' lists after it. On your list it shows as **Expired**.
- **Draft.** Save draft keeps the post private. Only staff who can open News & Circulars can see it.

> **Note:** The times you type use your device's clock. Make sure your phone or computer is set to Kampala time, otherwise a scheduled post will go out at the wrong moment.

Your List of Posts

News & Circulars lists every post, newest first. Each card shows the type, the status (**Draft**, **Published**, **Scheduled**, **Expired** or **Archived**), who it is aimed at, its publish and expiry times, and, for published posts, how many parents have read it. Use the filters at the top:

- Search by **title**.
- Filter by **type** or by **status**.
- Filter by **class**. This shows the posts aimed specifically at that class. Posts for All parents are not listed under a class.
- Filter by **From** and **To** dates, which match the publish date.
- **Clear filters** removes them all.

Editing, Archiving and Deleting

- **Preview** opens the post with its audience, schedule, read count and attachment, just as parents will see it.
- **Edit** changes any part of a post. Changes to a published post show to parents as soon as you save.
- **Archive** takes a post away from parents immediately but keeps it on your list. Use it if something was published by mistake. An archived post can be published again.
- **Delete** removes the post permanently, after you confirm. It cannot be undone, and it does not recall any SMS already sent about it.

Who Sees a Post

A parent sees a post only when all of these are true: it is Published, its publish time has arrived, it has not expired, and it is aimed at All parents, or at a class or section that at least one of their children, still active at the school, belongs to. A parent whose children are all deactivated sees only the posts for All parents.

Chapter 17: SMS Alerts for Posts

SCHOOL ADMIN ONLY

Not every parent has a smartphone or a portal login, so a published post can also be announced by SMS. Texting costs money, so only the School Admin can send an alert.

Sending an Alert

1. Open **News & Circulars**, find a **Published** post whose publish time has arrived, and click **Preview**.
2. In the **SMS alert** box, click **Send SMS alert**.
3. Read the number of phone numbers that will get the message, and how many of them belong to guardians with no portal login.
4. Check or edit the **SMS text**. The counter shows its length and how many SMS segments each message uses, and the total across all recipients.
5. Type your own number in **Test number** and click **Send a test to this number**. The test is marked [TEST] and does not count as the real send.
6. When the test looks right, click **Send to N numbers** and confirm.

Who Receives It

The guardians of active pupils in the post's audience: everyone for All parents, or those with children in the chosen classes or sections. Each phone number gets the message once, even if it belongs to several guardians or children, and the same number written in different ways counts as one. A pupil whose guardian has no phone number on file cannot be reached.

Cost and Safety

- A message of up to 160 characters is one SMS segment. Longer text, or text with special characters, uses more, and every segment is charged for every number.
- An alert can be sent only for a post that parents can see right now. Draft, Scheduled, Expired and Archived posts cannot be texted.
- Each post can be texted once. After that, the box shows when it was sent and asks you to tick **Send again** before another send.
- A sent SMS cannot be recalled. Every message is recorded in the SMS log, and the action appears in the Activity history.

Tip: The default text says to log in to the parent portal but does not give an address. Add your portal address to the message, so parents without a login know where to go, and include the key facts in the text itself, since some parents can only read the message.

Note: SMS reaches phones only when your school's SMS account is active and has credit. Always send a test to your own number first. If the test fails, the message names the reason; see Chapter 24.

Chapter 18: School Updates & the Parent Login

This chapter describes what parents see. School staff can use it to explain the system to parents.

Signing In

The school gives each parent an email address and a temporary password, along with the login link. One login covers every child the parent has at the school.

The Overview Page

Parents land on **My children**. Each child is shown with their class and their fee balances. A balance shows either the amount due or **Fully paid**. From here a parent can **Download term report** or open the **CA report**.

> **Note:** If a child has an outstanding balance, the term report button shows a message asking the parent to clear the balance to view the full report.

Paying Fees by MTN Mobile Money

Under any balance that is due, the parent taps **Pay via Mobile Money** and follows the on-screen steps. When MTN confirms the payment, the balance updates. The school does not need to enter it.

School Updates

- When there are unread posts, a blue banner at the top of the Overview page says how many, and lists the latest ones.
- The **School Updates** menu item shows a red number for unread posts.
- The **School Updates** page lists posts newest first. Each card shows the type badge, the date, the title and a short preview. New posts carry a **New** tag. The **All** and **Unread** tabs switch the view.
- **Read more** opens the full post. Any attachment has a **Download** button.
- Opening a post marks it as read. The tag, the banner and the red number then go away.

> **Note:** If a post has expired or the school has withdrawn it, opening its link shows a message that the update is no longer available. A parent sees only the updates meant for them: all parents, or the classes and sections their children are in.

Chapter 19: Activity History & Alerts

The system keeps a record of important actions: who did what, and when. All times are in Kampala time.

The Activity Page

Click **Activity** in the sidebar. What you see depends on your role:

- School Admin, Principal, Deputy Principal and Director see everyone's actions.
- Accountants, Teachers and Directors of Studies see **My activity**: only their own actions and sign-ins.
- Payment and fee entries are shown only to roles that can see finances.

The page has three tabs: **Changes** (what was done), **Sign-ins**, and, for those who see everyone, **Notifications**. Use **Person**, **Type**, **From** and **To** to narrow the list, then **Apply**. **Clear** only resets those filters. Long lists are split into pages with **Newer** and **Older** links.

Sign-ins

For those who see everyone, the Sign-ins tab shows each staff member's last sign-in and their failed attempts in the last 7 days. Three or more failures are shown in red. Below it is the sign-in history, with the result of each attempt: signed in, or failed (wrong password, account deactivated, or school suspended).

> **Note:** The history is read-only. Nobody, including the School Admin, can edit or delete an entry, and there is no button to clear it. That is what makes it trustworthy. It starts from the day the feature was switched on, so nothing earlier appears.

Alerts (the Bell)

School Admin, Director, Principal and Deputy Principal see a bell near the bottom of the sidebar. A red number shows unread alerts. Click it to see the latest, use **Mark read** or **Mark all as read**, or choose **See all notifications**.

An alert is created for critical actions only, and never for the person who did it:

- Staff accounts created, deactivated, reactivated or deleted, and staff password resets. These go to the Director, Principal, Deputy Principal and School Admin.
- Fee structures created, edited, reassigned or deleted, and balances brought forward. These go to the Director only, because finances are not visible to Principals.
- A pupil deleted, or deactivated or reactivated. These go to the Director, Principal and Deputy Principal.

Chapter 20: Year-End Transition

SCHOOL ADMIN / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL

At the end of the school year, the Year-End Transition does two jobs in one action: it creates next year's three terms, and it moves every class up or graduates it. Use it instead of promoting classes one at a time (Chapter 3) when the whole school is moving to a new year.

> **Note:** The transition cannot be undone automatically. Finish the old year first: complete exams and term reports, and download the termly summary report (Chapters 8, 10 and 12).

Running the Transition

1. Click **Year-End Transition** in the sidebar.
2. Under **New academic year**, check the **Year**. It is filled in as the year after your latest term.
3. Check the three terms. Each has a name, a start date and an end date, pre-filled with approximate dates that follow the usual calendar pattern. Adjust them to match the official Ministry of Education calendar for that year.
4. Under **Promote or graduate each class**, look at every class. Each shows how many active pupils it has, and a dropdown: **Graduate**, or **Promote to** another class.
5. Where the system found a clear next class (for example S1 to S2), it is already selected. Classes with no number pattern, such as one called "top class", default to **Graduate**, so review every row.
6. Click **Review changes**. A summary lists the new terms and what happens to each class. The first new term becomes the current term.
7. Check every row. If something is wrong, click **Back to edit**. If everything is right, click **Confirm and run year-end transition**.
8. A green message confirms the terms created, how many pupils were promoted, and how many graduated. Click **Go to Classes** to carry on.

After You Run It

- Create the fee structures for the new current term (Chapter 4), and generate transport and meal fees (Chapters 5 and 6). Fees are not carried over from the old year automatically.
- Only active pupils move. Graduated pupils are no longer active, but their history stays on record.
- The transition appears in the Activity history (Chapter 19).

Chapter 21: Nursery (Kindergarten) Ratings

SCHOOL ADMIN / TEACHER / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL / DIRECTOR OF STUDIES

Nursery classes follow a play-based curriculum, so pupils are not given percentage scores. Instead, the teacher rates each pupil in every learning area, once a term.

Before You Start

- The class must have its **Level** set to Nursery when it was created (Chapter 3). Only Nursery classes appear on this page.
- The learning areas must exist as Nursery subjects. If there are none, the page says so. Users who can manage subjects see an **Add detailed Kindergarten checklist** button, which adds a ready-made, detailed list of learning areas.
- A current academic term must be set up (Chapter 8).

Entering Ratings

1. Click **Kindergarten Ratings** in the sidebar.
2. Choose the class. The term shown beside it is the one the ratings belong to. Use the term dropdown at the top right to look at an earlier term.
3. The grid shows one row per active pupil and one column per learning area. In each cell, choose a rating from the list, or leave it as **Not rated**.
4. Click **Save ratings**. The page confirms how many ratings were saved.

> **Note:** Ratings you saved before load back automatically when you open a class, so you can return later to finish or change them. Saving needs at least one rating.

The ratings you save here are what appear on a Nursery pupil's terminal report, in place of percentage scores. See Chapter 12 for downloading reports.

Chapter 22: Continuous Assessment: Topics & AoI Scores

SCHOOL ADMIN / TEACHER / PRINCIPAL / DEPUTY PRINCIPAL / DIRECTOR OF STUDIES

Under the competency-based curriculum, teachers record how well each pupil did in an Activity of Integration (AoI) for each topic. The scores feed each pupil's continuous assessment (CA) report, and parents see a CA report link on their own page.

Step 1: Set Up the Topics

1. Click **Topics** in the sidebar.
2. Choose the class and the subject. Topics belong to one subject in one class, so Biology in S1 has its own list, separate from Biology in S2.
3. Type the name in **New topic name** and click **+ Add topic**. Topics are numbered in the order you add them.

- **Rename** changes a topic's name at any time.
- **Delete** removes a topic. It is switched off for a topic that already has recorded scores, which shows how many are scored.

Step 2: Enter the AoI Scores

1. Click **AoI Scores** in the sidebar.
2. Choose the class, the subject and the topic. The term the scores belong to is shown beside them.
3. In the table, give each pupil a score from the list: **1 - Basic**, **2 - Satisfactory**, or **3 - Accomplished**.
4. Click **Save scores**. The page confirms how many were saved.

> **Note:** Scores are kept per pupil, per topic and per term. Opening a topic again shows the scores already saved, so you can correct them. If a subject has no topics yet, the page links you to the Topics page.

Chapter 23: Connecting MTN Mobile Money

SCHOOL ADMIN ONLY

Parents can pay fees from their own login with MTN mobile money (Chapter 18). For the money to reach your school, the School Admin connects the school's own MTN account once. Each school uses its own account, so fee payments go straight to the school and are never held by Osubula Talks Solutions.

What You Need

A **Primary Subscription Key** for MTN's **Collections** product, from the MTN MoMo Developer site (momodeveloper.mtn.com), under Collections, then Subscription Keys.

Connecting the Account

1. Open the MTN mobile money setup in your school's **Settings**.
2. Paste the **Primary Subscription Key**.
3. Choose the **Environment**: **Sandbox (testing)** or **Production (real money)**.
4. Click **Connect MTN MoMo**. A green message confirms that fee payments will now collect directly into your school's own MTN account.

> **Note:** Start with Sandbox to test. Switch to Production once your MTN account is fully approved. If you need help with the switch, contact Osubula Talks Solutions.

> **Tip:** Treat the subscription key like a password. Do not share it in chat, email or screenshots.

Chapter 24: Frequently Asked Questions

A parent says they paid, but the balance still shows unpaid. What do I check?

Confirm the payment was actually recorded under Payments, and that it was recorded against the correct fee balance (the base fee, Transport, and Meals are all separate). A payment recorded against the wrong balance won't reduce the one the parent expects. For a payment the parent made by mobile money, the balance changes only once MTN confirms it.

Why doesn't a pupil have a Transport or Meals charge, even though I assigned them a zone?

Assigning a zone and generating fees are two separate steps. Go to Transport Zones or Meal Zones and click the Generate button for the current term, since assignment alone doesn't create the actual bill.

I promoted the wrong class by mistake. What now?

If nobody has been individually edited since, you can revert pupils one at a time from their own Edit page using the "Revert to [previous class]" link (see Chapter 3). There is currently no single button to undo an entire bulk promotion at once, only pupil by pupil.

Can I set up a fee structure before the term actually starts?

Yes, you can create it any time after the term itself has been added under Academic Terms. It will bill whichever pupils are currently active in that class the moment you create it. A pupil you add to that class afterwards is billed for it automatically.

A pupil was added in the middle of the term and has no fees. Why?

Check that a fee structure exists for that pupil's class for the current term (Chapter 4). A new pupil is billed automatically for the fee structures that already exist for their class. If there is none yet, create one, and it will bill everyone active in the class.

Why does my very first Termly Summary Report show almost everyone as "admitted this term"?

This happens when a whole roster was bulk-imported at once during onboarding, since every pupil's record was created on the same day, regardless of when they actually joined. Setting a real Admission Date on each pupil (Chapter 2) fixes this going forward; it's a one-time quirk of the very first report after import.

The system says "This phone number already belongs to a guardian". Which button do I press?

Read who it found and which children they are linked to. If it is the same parent, press **Same person - link**. If it is a different person who happens to share the number, such as a relative, press **No, this is a different person - add as new**. See Chapter 15.

A parent can't sign in, or doesn't see School Updates. What do I check?

Open one of their children and check that the parent is listed under Guardians and has portal access. If not, add the login with an email and a temporary password (Chapter 15). Also check that the child is still active at the school.

A parent says they can't see a circular I published.

Check that the post is Published (not Draft or Archived), that its publish time has arrived, and that it has not expired. Then check its audience: if it is aimed at certain classes or sections, the parent must have an active child in one of them. Open the post's Preview page to see its audience and schedule.

An SMS alert failed, or the test message never arrived.

The error message names a reason. The usual causes are that the school's SMS account is not active or has no credit, or the phone number is wrong. Send a test to your own number first (Chapter 17). If it still fails, contact Osubula Talks Solutions.

A teacher can't see any pupils or classes.

A teacher sees only the classes assigned to them, and sees nothing until at least one class is assigned. The School Admin assigns classes from the Staff page (Chapter 13).

Can I delete or clear the Activity history?

No. Nobody can edit or delete entries, and the Clear button only resets the filters on the page. The history is permanent by design (Chapter 19).

A Nursery class doesn't appear on the Kindergarten Ratings page.

Only classes whose Level is set to Nursery appear there. Check the class's level (Chapter 3). The page also needs Nursery learning areas and a current term (Chapter 21).

The year-end transition selected Graduate for a class that should move up.

The system suggests a next class only where it can see a number pattern, such as P4 to P5. For other names, such as "top class", it defaults to Graduate. Change the dropdown on that row before you review and confirm (Chapter 20).

I can't delete a topic.

A topic that already has AoI scores recorded cannot be deleted. Rename it instead (Chapter 22).

Chapter 25: Getting Help

If something in the system isn't working as this manual describes, or you're stuck on a task not covered here, contact Osubula Talks Solutions directly:

Phone / WhatsApp	+256 789 318 836
Email	osubuladan@gmail.com

> **Tip:** Before reaching out, it often helps to note down: which page you were on, what you clicked, and exactly what happened (or what error message appeared), since this makes it much faster to sort out.